

Hankun Lin

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EDUCATION

Purdue University

West Lafayette, IN

Ph.D. in Computer Science

2026 –

- Advisor: Prof. [Ruqi Zhang](#)

Nanjing University

Nanjing, China

B.S. in Computer Science and Technology

2022 – 2026

PUBLICATIONS

(* denotes equal contribution)

SEED: Self-Speculative Decoding via Implicit Encoder-Decoder

Hankun Lin*, Patrick Pynadath*, and Ruqi Zhang.

In *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems* (NeurIPS). Sydney, Australia. December 2026.

Gradient-Guided Reward Optimization for Inference-time Alignment

Hankun Lin and Ruqi Zhang.

In *Proceedings of the Conference on Uncertainty in Artificial Intelligence* (UAI). Amsterdam, Netherlands. August 2026.

Understanding LLMs' Cross-Lingual Context Retrieval: How Good It Is And Where It Comes From

Changjiang Gao, **Hankun Lin**, Xin Huang, Xue Han, Junlan Feng, Chao Deng, Jiajun Chen, and Shujian Huang.

In *Proceedings of the Conference on Empirical Methods in Natural Language Processing* (EMNLP). Suzhou, China.

November 2025.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

RZ-Lab @ Purdue University

Research Intern / Assistant

2025 –

NLP Group @ Nanjing University

Research Intern

2024 – 2025

SERVICE

- Conference Reviewer

NeurIPS 2026